Munshi — Product Requirements

Airtribe AI Builders Day · Track 02: AI for Commerce · 24 Oct 2026 · Bala

Overview

Munshi is an AI shop assistant that sets up a small shop online from a 5-minute voice conversation in the owner's language, then takes customer orders wherever buyers already are.

One-liner: Every shop's AI munshi. Talk to it, and it runs your shop online.

Problem: India has over 6 crore small businesses. Most kiranas, bakeries and local stores still take orders by phone, WhatsApp and notebook. Store builders exist, but most small owners never finish setting one up or stop using it.

Insight (the non-obvious truth):

1. Small shops don't need a website; they need someone to handle orders. Neighbourhood buyers will never browse a kirana's website. They call or send a WhatsApp message.
2. Owners can't do DIY. Typing forms and uploading 200 products in English is the real barrier, not price.
3. A small shop's edge over quick commerce is knowing its customers. That knowledge lives only in the owner's head, and nothing captures it.

Differentiation

Dukaan and WhatsApp Business are tools the owner operates; Munshi is staff that does the work and asks the owner only to approve.

	Dukaan / WhatsApp Business	Munshi
Setup	Owner fills forms, mostly in English	Owner talks for 5 minutes in Kannada, Hindi, Tamil or English
Catalog	Owner types every product	Owner picks a category template or films a shelf; agent drafts listings
How buyers order	Must visit a store link	A phone call, WhatsApp text, voice note or store link; agent turns any of them into an order
Owner's daily work	Manage a dashboard	Tap Approve on order alerts
Customer memory	None	Agent remembers regulars and their usual orders

Positioning line for the pitch: "Dukaan gave shops a website. Munshi gives them a helper."

Context: Dukaan cut about 70% of its headcount searching for fit and moved upmarket to compete with Shopify, and rival Bikayi exited kirana tech (source: The Ken). That supports our insight: the website was never the bottleneck.

Users and personas

Munshi has two sides: the shop owner who pays, and the buyers who order.

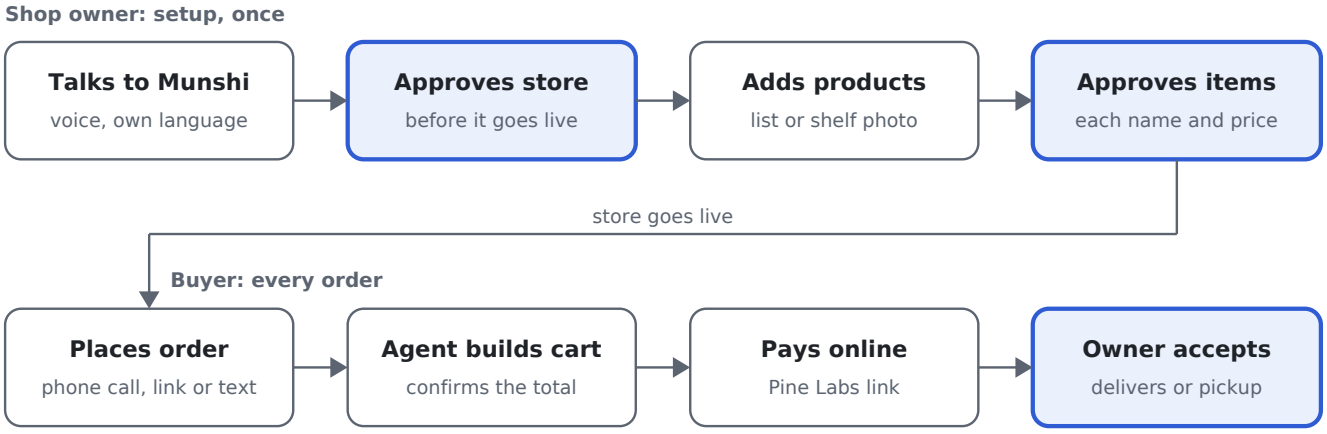
Persona	Who	Needs	Frustrations today
Ganesh, kirana owner (primary, payer)	Runs a grocery store in Jayanagar, 45, speaks Kannada, uses WhatsApp daily, never opens a laptop	Take more orders without hiring; keep regulars loyal against quick-commerce apps	Missed calls during rush hour; orders lost in WhatsApp chats; store apps feel too complicated

Persona	Who	Needs	Frustrations today
Lakshmi, home baker (secondary payer)	Sells cakes and snacks from home through Instagram and WhatsApp	A simple order and payment link; fewer back-and-forth messages	Chasing payments; repeating the same menu and prices to every customer
Mrs. Rao, regular buyer	65, lives nearby, prefers voice notes to typing	Order her usual items quickly, pay easily	Typing lists; apps in English
Arjun, busy buyer	30, works long hours, uses UPI for everything	Order from the trusted local shop as easily as from a delivery app	Calling the shop and waiting on hold

Core user journeys

The owner sets up once in about 10 minutes by talking and approving; after that, every buyer order needs only one tap from the owner.

The owner only talks and approves; agents do the rest



Highlighted steps need the owner's approval

The demo follows this exact path end to end: owner speaks, store appears, shelf photo adds items, a buyer phones the shop's Munshi number and orders by voice, pays by Pine Labs link, owner accepts.

Functional requirements

P0 items must work live by submission; P1 items are built if time allows; P2 items appear only in the pitch.

ID	User story	Acceptance criteria	Priority
F1	As an owner, I sign up with my phone number and pay a ₹49 activation fee	Phone OTP or simple sign-up works; Pine Labs payment completes; payment is logged with a timestamp	P0
F2	As an owner, I describe my shop by voice or text in my language, in the app or by calling Munshi's number	ElevenLabs transcribes Kannada, Hindi and English; the call works over Vobiz; agent asks follow-ups for name, category, address, timings, delivery or pickup	P0
F3	As an owner, I see a draft store page and approve it	Store page is generated from a template with my details; nothing is public until I tap Approve	P0
F4	As an owner, I add products from a category template	I pick a category, tick items I stock, and set prices by voice or text	P0
F5	As an owner, I add products by photographing a shelf	Agent returns draft items with name, size and suggested price; I approve, edit or delete each	P0
F6	As an owner, I add or change a product by voice	"Aashirvaad atta 5 kilo 260 rupees" creates or updates an item card	P1

ID	User story	Acceptance criteria	Priority
F7	As a buyer, I browse the store link and order	Items, prices and a cart work on mobile; order captures name, phone, address or pickup	P0
F14	As a buyer, I order by calling the shop's Munshi number	Vobiz answers the call; an ElevenLabs voice agent takes items in Kannada, Hindi or English, reads back the total, and sends a Pine Labs link by SMS; order waits for owner acceptance	P0
F8	As a buyer, I order by sending a text or voice note	Agent turns free text or voice into matched items and quantities, confirms the total, and asks before creating the order	P1
F9	As a buyer, I pay through Pine Labs	Payment link or checkout completes; order shows Paid; payment logged	P0
F10	As an owner, I get an alert for each order and accept or reject it	Alert by SMS, in-app, or a short Vobiz voice call during rush hour; one tap or a spoken "yes" accepts; buyer is notified	P0
F11	As an owner, I see orders and revenue	Simple list of orders with status, amount and time	P1
F12	As an owner, I approve repeat-order nudges to regulars	Agent drafts "your usual order?" messages; owner approves before sending	P2
F13	As an organiser or judge, I can verify activity	Admin view shows timestamped sign-ups, payments, calls and agent logs for proof screenshots	P0

Agents on AgenticOrg

Four agents run on AgenticOrg, each with a clear role, a fixed set of tools, and at least one decision the owner must approve. The brief requires only one; the Onboarding and Order agents are P0.

Agent	Role	Tools it may use	Human must approve	Priority
Onboarding agent	Interviews the owner in their language and builds the shop profile and store page	ElevenLabs voice, Vobiz phone line, LLM, store database (write draft only)	Store page before it goes public	P0
Catalog agent	Creates product listings from templates, shelf photos and voice	Vision model, product template library, catalog database (draft only)	Every new item and price	P0
Order agent	Understands buyer messages, builds the cart, sends the Pine Labs link, notifies the owner	LLM, catalog lookup, ElevenLabs voice and Vobiz calls, Pine Labs payment links, SMS	Accept or reject each order; any price change or discount	P0
Relationship agent	Spots regulars and drafts repeat-order nudges	Order history, messaging (draft only)	Every nudge before it is sent	P2

Guardrails

- No agent publishes, charges, discounts or messages a buyer in the owner's name without approval.
- Every agent action is written to an activity log with a timestamp, for proof submission and judge checks.
- When the agent is unsure (unclear item, unknown price), it asks the owner instead of guessing.

Catalog creation methods

Today we build the category template as the reliable base, shelf-photo scan as the showstopper, and voice entry for edits.

Method	How it works	Best for	Build today?
Category template	Owner picks kirana, bakery, stationery etc.; ticks items from a preloaded list of about 200 common products; says prices	Packaged goods, fast first 20 items	Yes (P0)
Shelf photo scan	Owner photographs a shelf; vision model identifies products and drafts name, size and suggested price	Wow moment; quick bulk add	Yes (P0)
Voice entry	Owner says item, size and price; agent creates or updates the card	One-off additions and price changes	Yes (P1)
Distributor bill photo	Agent reads a wholesaler invoice and suggests selling prices	Adding 20 to 30 items at once	Later
Barcode scan	Scan pulls name and image from an open product database	Packaged goods accuracy	Later
Price board photo	Reads handwritten menus and price boards	Tea stalls, tiffin centres, bakeries	Later

Open question: which open product database gives the best coverage of Indian brands for templates and images (Open Food Facts is the first candidate).

Screens

Nine mobile-first screens cover the P0 journey; everything is designed for a phone held in one hand.

Owner app

1. **Welcome and sign-up:** language picker (Kannada, Hindi, English), phone number, ₹49 activation via Pine Labs.
2. **Talk to Munshi:** a big mic button and chat transcript; the agent asks about the shop one question at a time.
3. **Store preview:** generated store page with name, tagline, timings, location; buttons Approve and Change.
4. **Add products:** three tiles: Pick from list, Scan shelf, Speak an item.
5. **Review drafts:** cards for AI-detected items with name, size, price; Approve, Edit, Delete on each.
6. **Orders:** incoming orders with items, total, paid status; Accept or Reject.

Buyer side

- **Store page:** shop header, categories, product list with Add buttons, chat bubble.
- **Cart and checkout:** items, total, name, phone, address or pickup, Pay with Pine Labs.
- **Order status:** Paid, Accepted by shop, Ready or Out for delivery.

Admin (internal)

- **Proof dashboard:** timestamped sign-ups, payments, orders and agent actions for submission screenshots.

Tech architecture and data model

One multi-tenant web app serves every shop from a single storefront template filled with data; the AI never writes code per shop. Every tool in the event toolkit has a job.

Toolkit usage

Tool	How Munshi uses it	Toolkit
AgenticOrg by Pine Labs	Runs the Onboarding, Catalog and Order agents with owner approvals and timestamped activity logs	Required
Pine Labs payments	₹49 activation fee; buyer checkout on the store page; payment links sent by SMS after phone orders	Required
Replit	Build and iterate the app quickly	Credits
Render	Hosts the web app, API, Postgres and the call webhooks on a public URL	Credits
ElevenLabs	Speech-to-text and natural voice in Kannada, Hindi and English for onboarding and phone orders	Credits
Vobiz	Phone line for Munshi: buyers call to order, owners call to set up, and Munshi places confirmation and order-alert calls	Credits
Greptile	AI review of every pull request before Render deploys, so the live demo doesn't break	Credits
Claude (or another multimodal LLM)	Order understanding, onboarding interview, shelf photo recognition	Outside toolkit
SMS, WhatsApp	Payment links and owner alerts; WhatsApp is P1	Outside toolkit

Build stack

Layer	Choice
App	Next.js (React + TypeScript): owner screens, buyer store pages (/s/shop-slug) and API routes in one app
Styling	Tailwind CSS, mobile-first
Database	Postgres on Render, Prisma for schema and queries
LLM	Claude Sonnet 5.5 for onboarding and shelf photos; Claude Haiku 5.5 for fast order parsing on calls
Voice fallback	Sarvam AI if ElevenLabs Kannada quality is poor
Sign-up	Phone number + name, no OTP today

Data model

Table	Key fields
shops	id, slug, owner_name, phone, language, category, address, timings, delivery_mode, status (draft / live), activation_paid_at
products	id, shop_id, name, size, price, image_url, source (template / photo / voice), status (draft / approved)
buyers	id, shop_id, name, phone, address
orders	id, shop_id, buyer_id, items (json), total, channel (web / message / voice), payment_status, owner_decision, created_at
payments	id, order_id or shop_id, pine_labs_ref, amount, status, paid_at
agent_logs	id, shop_id, agent, action, input_summary, output_summary, needs_approval, approved_by, created_at

Business model and payments

The shop owner pays; buyers pay the shop through Munshi for their orders.

- **Today:** ₹49 one-time activation fee per shop through Pine Labs. These owners are our paying users.

- **Buyer orders:** paid through Pine Labs at checkout. Buyers who sign up and order count as free users.
- **Later:** ₹199 to ₹299 per month subscription, or a small fee per order once volume grows. Upsells: delivery partner integration, repeat-order campaigns.

Why charge the owner, not the buyer: the brief counts payments for our product. An owner's activation fee is unambiguous; a buyer paying for groceries is the shop's revenue, not ours.

Open question: confirm with Pine Labs mentors whether buyer order payments routed through Munshi also count as paying users.

Scope

Today's build is the shortest path from an owner's first sentence to a buyer's paid order.

In scope today (P0)

- Voice or text onboarding in Kannada, Hindi, English
- Store page from template, owner approval before publishing
- Catalog from category template and shelf photo, owner approves each item
- Buyer ordering on the store link or by phone call to Munshi (Vobiz + ElevenLabs), paid through Pine Labs
- Owner order alert with Accept or Reject
- ₹49 activation fee through Pine Labs
- Agent activity log and proof dashboard

Stretch today (P1)

- Ordering by WhatsApp text or voice note
- Voice entry for products
- Owner order list and revenue view

Out of scope today (pitch only)

- Delivery partner or ONDC integration (today the shop delivers or the buyer picks up)
- Repeat-order nudges, credit (khata), inventory tracking, analytics
- Custom domains, social media assets
- Agent-to-agent commerce: a buyer's AI assistant ordering from Munshi directly

Success metrics and judging

By 7:00 PM: at least 5 shops paying ₹49, 20+ total users from outside the team, and 1 real order paid end to end.

Target by 7 PM	Goal	Stretch
Shops activated and paid	5	10
Total users (owners + buyers)	20	40
Products listed	100	300
Paid buyer orders	1	5
Agent actions approved by owners	30	100

How Munshi scores on each judging criterion

Criterion	Weight R1 / R2	Our evidence
Problem and insight	25% / 20%	Shops need order handling, not websites; owners can't do DIY; store builders struggled for exactly this reason
Ambition and originality	15% / 20%	A helper that does the work, not a DIY builder; voice-first in local languages; orders from any channel
Agentic depth	15% / 20%	Onboarding, Catalog and Order agents on AgenticOrg do work a shop would pay a helper for, with owner approval at every money or publishing step
Traction	25% / 30%	Paying shop owners plus real buyers; timestamped logs
Demo and polish	20% / 10%	Live: owner speaks in Kannada, store appears, shelf photo adds items, buyer phones in an order in Kannada, payment lands

Submission checklist

- ☐ Live public URL
- ☐ Proof screenshots: sign-ups, payments, agent logs, all timestamped
- ☐ Demo video, 2 minutes or less, showing the agent and the owner approval step
- ☐ LinkedIn post plus X or Instagram post, tagging Airtribe and Pine Labs
- ☐ Pitch rehearsed: who pays, why now, how it grows

Risks and mitigations

The two biggest risks are local-language voice quality and recruiting enough real shop owners by 7 PM.

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Kannada voice quality or Vobiz call setup fails	Onboarding demo fails	Test ElevenLabs Kannada and a Vobiz call in the first hour; ask the Vobiz help desk early; in-browser voice as fallback; typed input always available
Too few real shop owners sign up	Traction score drops	Start recruiting by 2 PM through family, friends and nearby shops; one person owns growth full time
Shelf photo recognition misreads items	Wrong listings	Owner approves every item; category template is the fallback
WhatsApp Business API setup is slow	No order alerts	SMS or in-app alerts first; WhatsApp is P1
Pine Labs integration takes longer than expected	No payment proof	Start payment integration first, in parallel; ask Pine Labs help desk early
Judges see it as another Dukaan	Originality score drops	Lead the pitch with the insight and the helper positioning, not the website
Too much scope for one day	Nothing works end to end	Freeze P0 list; build one full order flow before any polish

Build plan to 7 PM

One complete order flow must work by 3:30 PM; everything after that is recruiting users, polish and submission.

Team split

Role	Owns	Delivers
Voice and onboarding	Onboarding agent, ElevenLabs voice, Vobiz phone line	F2, F3, F14

Role	Owns	Delivers
Storefront	Template, store page, buyer cart	F7, F10
Catalog	Category templates, shelf photo flow	F4, F5, F6
Payments and data	Pine Labs, database, agent logs, proof dashboard	F1, F9, F13
Growth (if 5 people)	Recruiting shops and buyers, demo video, social posts	Traction, submission

Hour by hour

Time	What happens
1:00 to 1:30 PM	Freeze P0 scope; set up repo, Render, database; test ElevenLabs Kannada and a Vobiz call; connect Greptile to the repo; start Pine Labs integration
1:30 to 3:30 PM	Build onboarding, store template, category catalog, checkout with Pine Labs; growth lines up 10+ shop owners
3:30 PM	First full flow live: owner onboards, adds items, buyer orders and pays
3:30 to 5:00 PM	Shelf photo scan, phone ordering, order alerts, proof dashboard; Greptile reviews every pull request before Render deploys; onboard first real shops and collect ₹49 activations
5:00 to 6:00 PM	Record demo video, publish LinkedIn and X posts, take timestamped proof screenshots, submit
6:00 to 7:00 PM	Keep onboarding shops and buyers for the 7 PM count; rehearse the stage pitch

Open question: confirm the Round 1 submission deadline at the help desk and shift the 5:00 PM block if it is earlier.

Source

The Ken: Dukaan's anti-Shopify pitch finds one big taker and many small sceptics — the-ken.com